



'My Volkswagen' App

Redefining Customer Experience

Case Study

This case was written by **Keka Lahiri** and reviewed by **K. Bhagyalakshmi**, Amity Research Centers Headquarter, Bangalore. It is intended to be used as the basis for class discussion rather than to illustrate either effective or ineffective handling of a management situation. The case was compiled from published sources.

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Case Study

"We want to offer our customers genuine added value with artificial intelligence. We aim to link external digital ecosystems with the vehicle, creating an even better product experience. Collaboration with technology companies is crucially important for us. In the future, we intend to simplify cooperation in organisational and cultural terms."

– Oliver Blume, CEO, Volkswagen-Porsche

During the month of February 2024, Volkswagen, the Germany based car maker, had introduced 'My Volkswagen' App, as the perfect digital companion to woo the customers in India. Digital experts acknowledged that the software application was quite user-friendly harnessing intuitive features to define complete consumer convenience. With the help of the app, consumers could book service appointments, explore recent service offerings, besides, scheduling test drives of a new Volkswagen model. Thus, the 'My Volkswagen' app would allow customers to be in touch with the brand, even when they were away, or not driving.

The digital app was a standard feature in cars like 'Polo GT TSI' and 'Vento Highline Plus' and came with a free three-year subscription and free three-year warranty for the customers. The digital application was meant to improve the user experience holistically through the introduction of certain additional features (**Exhibit I**) to drive customer engagement.

Exhibit I My Volkswagen App: A Snapshot



Source: Nadkarni Aditya, "Volkswagen India launches My Volkswagen Connect", <https://www.carwale.com/news/volkswagen-india-launches-my-volkswagen-connect>, October 27th 2020

Besides, the digital app could allow the users to have a check on the fuel usage as well. If users were interested in calculating the equated monthly installments associated with the cost of owning a Volkswagen model, the digital app would provide an indicative financial transparency and planning. At the same time, the digital app would provide advantages like location tracking, geo fencing, time fencing etc. And, in case the user would like to assess his driving behavior along with driving performance 'My Volkswagen' App, would provide the necessary feedback.

In addition to the above, the car owner could find a dealership store in the vicinity, while driving his car. Earlier during 2020, the German car brand had launched My Volkswagen Connect, globally. The digital app could be swiftly accessed by connecting a dongle with the on-board diagnostics (OBD) port of the car. The digital app was programmed to provide an analytical report in accordance with certain determining aspects of user interest.

In addition, to helping consumers to locate destinations of interest, the digital app could be downloaded on any smartphone, while also helping drivers to reach out to customer care or look for roadside assistance. The digital app was quite user friendly, and enabled consumers to upload documents related to car ownership online. A major advantage of using the digital app was that the customers could automatically set up renewal reminders in order to activate vehicle insurance besides receiving 'over the air' (OTA) software updates.

On the launch of such digital application, Steffen Knapp (Steffen), Director, Volkswagen Passenger Cars India, said, "At Volkswagen India, we have relentlessly been working towards enhancing and providing our customers the best of technology and connected solutions. Today, we introduced the upgraded 'My Volkswagen Connect' app that offers customer convenience and safety at their fingertips. Customers will have access to real-time vehicle analysis and assistance that would make them aware of their vehicle condition, driving patterns, and enhance the overall fun-to-drive experience that a Volkswagen stands for." (Exhibit II).

Exhibit II

My Volkswagen App: Driving User Experience?



Source: Contractor Sameer, "My Volkswagen Connect App Launched; Brings Connected Tech To VW Cars In India", <https://www.carandbike.com/news/my-volkswagen-connect-app-launched-brings-connected-tech-to-vw-cars-in-india-2316796>, October 28th 2020

The digital application was a valid testament of Volkswagen promoting unwavering customer centricity. Ashish Gupta, the brand director, Volkswagen Passenger Cars India, on the launch of the app stated, “We are thrilled to introduce the new ‘My Volkswagen’ app, a testament to our unwavering commitment to customer centricity. This app has been designed as a one-stop solution that empowers our customers, offering control and convenience throughout their mobility journey with Volkswagen. With the ‘My Volkswagen’ app, we have redefined the customer experience, extending beyond the boundaries of connectivity to provide a comprehensive suite of features, allowing both existing and prospecting customers to explore a host of services, functions & features on a single platform. At Volkswagen, we believe in technology that not only connects but also enriches lives – Feel like you’re in a Volkswagen, even where you’re not.”

It was quite interesting to note that, Volkswagen had allowed the users an option for getting a real time assessment of driving behavior. The digitised tool analysed road performance quotient for the Volkswagen drivers. This required the customers to connect to the Volkswagen telematics solution (dongle) to avail this facility. Further to this, the ‘My Volkswagen’ App included a 'Digital Owner's Manual' (DOM), offering extensive information on certain signs and signals guiding various internal features and functions. Simultaneously, the DOM supported various search options such as 'type-search,' 'voice command,' and 'scan the image.' Safety of the automobile drivers remained to be a priority for the German car maker and digital app of Volkswagen ensured the same.

It was quite interesting to note that associate functionalities like Apple CarPlay and Android Auto had contributed largely towards an enhanced technical experience for the consumers. Dirk Hilgenberg (Dirk) the CEO of Cariad, Volkswagen’s in-house software division had acknowledged, “It’s a new level of digital experiences we want to show.” Comparing such digital applications built by the third party vendors Dirk continued further, “We can combine and leverage with each other creating an immersive experience, especially as far as gaming, relaxing is concerned.”

Dirk acknowledged that the ultimate business objective was to include ‘in-office functionalities’, right from the inception of a product design. Volkswagen was also in the process of initiating native Google maps integration within the designed automobile models. The German brand was probably the latest brand to join the ‘in-car app party’. Professionals working with the Volkswagen group acknowledged that, this was just the tip of the iceberg, as the German brand was gradually preparing itself to launch immersive digital platforms to completely govern car operations in the future. However, many of the users acknowledged that the application was not quite in sync with the user expectations. Taking several minutes to operate successfully on various digital platforms, Volkswagen users post the launch expected the German auto brand to focus more on modernisation of the application to promote increased agility in the long run.

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